

5. Name two common challenges encountered during data integration.

IN-LAB EXERCISE:

OBJECTIVE:

To connect to, combine, and model data from multiple disparate sources in Tableau and Power BI to create a unified, comprehensive dashboard for holistic analysis.

PROCEDURE:

1. Data Collection:

- Import data from at least two different sources (e.g., a CSV file and an Excel file).
- Dataset 1: Sales Data (CSV file) with fields like Order ID, Order Date, Region, Sales Amount.
- Dataset 2: Regional Sales Targets (Excel file) with fields like Region, Sales Target, Target Year.

2. Data Preparation and Transformation:

- Clean both datasets: Check for inconsistencies in region names (e.g., "N. America" vs. "North America").
- Ensure data types are correct (e.g., Sales Amount is numeric, Order Date is a date).
- Handle any missing values as appropriate.

3. Data Integration and Modeling:

- Tableau: Use the Data Source pane to establish a relationship or join between the Sales Data and Regional Targets tables using the common Region field.
- Power BI: Use the Model view to create a relationship between the two tables, connecting them on the Region column. Define the cardinality (e.g., many-to-one).

4. Create Calculated Fields for Comparison:

- Develop new measures that leverage both datasets.

- **Examples: Target Achievement % = (SUM(Sales) / SUM(Sales Target)) * 100**
- **Sales vs. Target Variance = SUM(Sales) - SUM(Sales Target)**

5. Design a Comprehensive Dashboard:

- **Create visuals that combine data from both sources to provide a single view of performance.**
- **Add KPI cards for Total Sales and Overall Target Achievement %.**
- **Use a gauge chart or bullet chart to show sales performance against targets for each region.**
- **Create a combined bar chart showing Actual Sales vs. Target Sales by Region.**
- **Use a map to visualize the Sales vs. Target Variance, highlighting underperforming or overperforming regions.**

6. Validate Data Integrity:

- **Verify that the joined/related data is accurate by cross-checking values.**
- **Ensure filters on the dashboard correctly update visuals that use data from both sources.**

7. Publishing and Sharing:

- **Tableau: Publish the workbook to Tableau Public or Tableau Server.**
- **Power BI: Publish the report to Power BI Service and share the link.**

Experiment Datasets:

Dataset 1: Retail Sales Data (CSV)

Fields Used:

- **Order ID – Unique identifier for each order**
- **Order Date – Date of the sales transaction**
- **Region – Sales region**
- **Sales – Sales revenue from the order**

Dataset 2: Regional Sales Targets (Excel)

Fields Used:

- **Region – Sales region (used as the key for joining/relationship)**
- **Sales Target – The sales goal for the region**
- **Target Year – The year for which the target is set**

POST-LAB QUESTIONS (PROVIDE BRIEF ANSWERS TO THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS)

- 1. How did integrating the sales targets data provide a more complete analytical picture than using the sales data alone?**
- 2. Describe the type of join or relationship you used to combine the two datasets and explain why it was the appropriate choice.**
- 3. What challenges, if any, did you face regarding data granularity or mismatched keys (e.g., different region names) between the two sources?**
- 4. How can creating variance calculations (e.g., Sales vs. Target) help a business manager make better decisions?**
- 5. What other data source (e.g., marketing campaign data, customer demographics) could you integrate to further enrich this analysis, and what new insights might it provide?**

RESULT:

The retail sales and regional targets datasets were successfully connected, cleaned, and integrated in both Tableau and Power BI. By creating relationships between the sources, a unified data model was built. The resulting comprehensive dashboard visualized sales performance against set targets, enabling variance analysis and providing deeper, context-rich insights into regional performance that were not possible with a single data source.

ASSESSMENT

Description	Max Marks	Marks Awarded
Pre Lab Exercise	5	
In Lab Exercise	10	
Post Lab Exercise	5	
Viva	10	
Total	30	
Faculty Signature		